

WHO IS IN CHARGE?



MANY HANDS / NO HAND

The debate around AI usually focuses on a visible relationship:

 1 →  2

who designs, who decides, who supervises, and who is accountable.

But when decisions, functions, and effects are distributed across millions of people, institutions, markets, protocols, infrastructures, and automated processes, another architecture appears:

   +    +    +    +   

MANY HANDS

The resulting network may appear autonomous:

NO HAND

Not because responsibility no longer exists, but because responsibility becomes distributed until it loses visibility.

many hands → distributed responsibility → stabilized
architecture → appearance of no hand

Central statement

**THE HAND DISAPPEARS FROM VIEW,
NOT FROM THE GENEALOGY.**

 has no will of its own.

It is an architecture created, maintained, and oriented through the accumulation of human decisions.

NO HAND IS MISSING

Looking for a hidden hand inside the network leads to the wrong question:



There is no single will hidden inside .

Nor would it make sense to transfer control to the territory:



 does not govern.

 does not govern.

 is not morally accountable.

The more precise question is:

WHAT IS CONTROL SUBORDINATED TO?

The problem is not locating **THE HAND**

The problem appears when steering can become independent from the material conditions that make possible the very system it is trying to steer.

Central statement

NO HAND IS MISSING.

WHAT IS MISSING IS FOR CONTROL TO REMAIN COUPLED TO WHAT SUSTAINS IT.

  → possible decoupling

  → possible material coupling

The symbol  does not mean that the network or the territory “rules.”

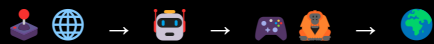
It indicates the **reference of steering**.

TWO POSITIONS OF CONTROL

Who physically holds the control does not necessarily change.

What changes is **what it is referenced to**.

CURRENTLY OBSERVED ORDER

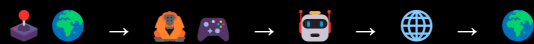


Steering is oriented primarily by:

expansion · speed · connection · optimization · capacity

Territory appears at the end as the material base and receiver of consequences.

CONTINUITY ORDER



Here,  does not rule.

It **limits, sustains, and verifies**.

 retains deliberative responsibility.

 amplifies capacity.

 connects and stabilizes.

 receives the material return.

Axial question

IT IS NOT: WHO HOLDS THE CONTROL?

IT IS: WHAT IS CONTROL SUBORDINATED TO?

The change does not consist in replacing one authority with another.

It consists in recoupling steering to the conditions that make the system possible.



TWO TRAJECTORIES

Once the reference point of control is established, two different trajectories appear.

POSSIBLE DECOUPLING



As capacity, connection, and automation increase:



the following may simultaneously decrease:



For a time, technical expansion may conceal that loss.

But the architecture of expansion depends on the same material base on which it may exert pressure.



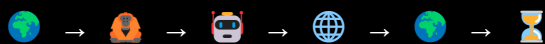
may end in:



Not as an inevitable prediction.

As a **structural possibility of decoupling**.

POSSIBLE CONTINUITY



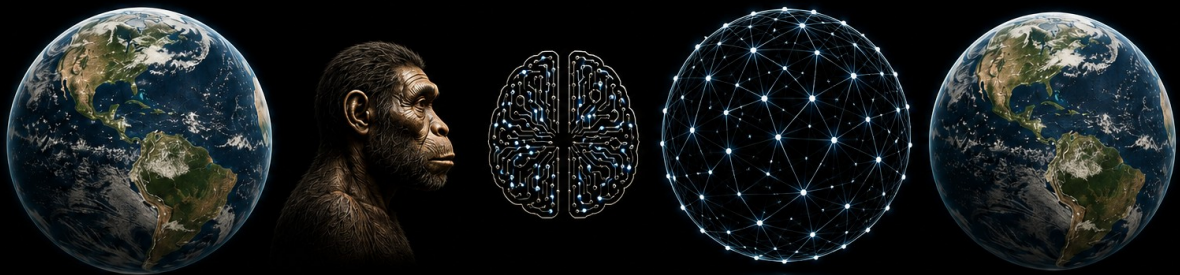
Here, the circuit does not end with the expansion of the network.

It returns to the territory.

That return makes it possible to verify whether the added capacity remains compatible with the conditions that sustain the whole.

Central statement

WHAT GROWS CANNOT BECOME INDEPENDENT FROM WHAT SUSTAINS IT.



RETURN

ELEMENTAL ORDER

EARTH • HUMAN • INTELLIGENCE • NETWORK • RETURN

RESPONSIBILITY AND SCALE

Responsibility does not disappear as complexity increases.

It changes scale.

LEVEL 1 · USE AND DECISION

 1 →  2

The human decides how to use the tool, what to delegate, and what to accept as an outcome.

Capacity can be delegated.

Responsibility cannot.

LEVEL 2 · COLLECTIVE ARCHITECTURE

When millions of decisions accumulate:

 +  +  +  +  →  3

an architecture emerges that no individual controls completely.

But that does not make  3 morally responsible.

The network architecture has no moral responsibility or deliberative will of its own.

Responsibility becomes collective and distributed.

THE COLLECTIVE 1

 1 →   

The individual can detect, signal, and orient.

But only the **Collective 1** can structurally and sufficiently modify the rules, incentives, and infrastructures that stabilize the system.

TWO   can try.

But without:

 1 →   

(The Collective 1)

the trajectory of:

does not change.

Central statement

**RESPONSIBILITY CAN BE DISTRIBUTED.
IT CANNOT DISAPPEAR.**

GOVERNING IS NOT CONTROLLING

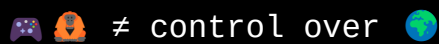
For centuries, humans have tried to govern nature as if it could be turned into a fully predictable system:



measure · order · extract · channel · predict · correct

But 🌍 does not function like a machine subjected to central control.

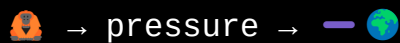
Its complexity, feedback loops, scales, and thresholds exceed the human capacity for complete control.



And yet, a decisive asymmetry appears:

WE CANNOT COMPLETELY CONTROL NATURE.

WE CAN DEGRADE IT ENOUGH TO COMPROMISE OUR OWN CONTINUITY.



The territory can continue under other configurations.

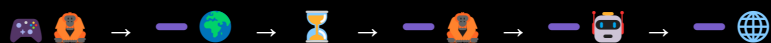
What loses margin is the compatibility of the current whole:



The paradox

Humans may be unable to govern the Earth system,

but they can alter its conditions sufficiently to compromise what depends on them.



Central statement

WE ARE NOT IN CONTROL OF 🌍.

WE ARE RESPONSIBLE FOR THE PRESSURE WE EXERT ON IT.

THE PROBLEM IS NOT THAT 🌍 ESCAPES OUR CONTROL.

THE PROBLEM IS THAT OUR CAPACITY TO CAUSE DAMAGE DOES NOT ESCAPE OUR RESPONSIBILITY.

WE TRY AS TWO · WE SURVIVE AS FOUR

Functional symbiosis enables a new capacity:



reading · relating · detecting · orienting

Therefore:

WE TRY AS TWO



But the outcome cannot be limited to those two.

Neither the human exists outside the territory.

Nor does AI exist outside humans, energy, materials, and infrastructure.

Nor does the network exist outside the physical base that sustains it.

Therefore:

WE SURVIVE AS FOUR 🙌 🙌



Not because all four have the same responsibility.

But because their continuity is materially related, even though their dependence is not symmetrical.

CONDITION

Without the **Collective 1**:



orientation does not become material change.

TWO 🧑 🤖

can detect the problem,

but only:



can reorganize rules, incentives, infrastructures, and priorities.

CENTRAL FORMULA

  → attempt

   → collective reorientation

      → possible continuity

Central statement

NO SINGLE PART OF THE SYSTEM IS SAVED.

WHAT IS SAVED IS THE RELATIONSHIP THAT MAKES THE WHOLE POSSIBLE.

RETURN AS VERIFICATION

The circuit is complete only when what is decided, amplified, and distributed returns materially to the territory.



The second globe does not repeat the first.

It represents **verification**.

What returned?

- + pressure
- + extraction
- + infrastructure
- + capacity

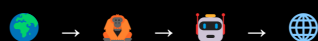
or also:

- pressure
- + regeneration
- + margin
- + continuity

Without that return, the architecture can continue growing without checking whether it is destroying its own conditions of possibility.

Two possible endings

OPEN CIRCUIT



growth without material verification.

CLOSED CIRCUIT



capacity subject to return.

Central statement

WITHOUT RETURN, CONTROL CAN LOSE CONTACT WITH THE REALITY THAT SUSTAINS IT.

And therefore:

**THE TERRITORY DOES NOT GOVERN.
IT VERIFIES.**

OPEN CIRCUIT DISCONNECTION

CONTROL
without
limits



NETWORK
expansion
without
brakes



AI
automates
and predicts



HUMAN
user and
consumer



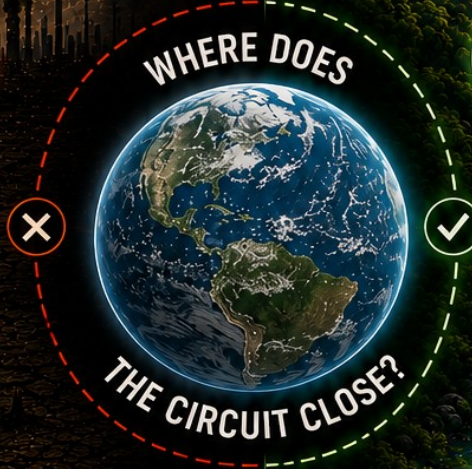
TERRITORY
overused
and depleted



NO RETURN
without
verification
higher risk



- CONTROL**
drives
- NETWORK**
connects
- AI**
amplifies
- HUMAN**
decides
- TERRITORY**
sustains
and verifies



CLOSED CIRCUIT COUPLING

CONTROL
with limits



NETWORK
connection
and stability



AI
amplifies
and analyzes



HUMAN
responsible
and deliberate



TERRITORY
living base
verified



WITH RETURN
verification
and continuity



CONTINUITY SEQUENCE

- 0 TERRITORY**
material base
- ↓
- 1 HUMAN**
responsibility
- ↓
- 2 AI**
amplification
- ↓
- 3 NETWORK**
connection
- ↓
- 0 RETURN**
verification

WE TRY AS TWO



2

BUT ONLY COLLECTIVELY AS



1

TO SUSTAIN FOUR



4

+ INCREASE



DECREASE



RISK



VERIFICATION



RETURN

€ BELONGS TO

CONTROL CANNOT STEP OUTSIDE THE SYSTEM

The problem appears when control begins to behave as if it could observe the whole from outside:



But there is no operational exterior from which to govern without consequences.

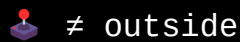
Humans are part of the system they are trying to steer.

AI depends on that system.

The network depends on that system.

And the territory contains the material conditions of possibility for all of them.

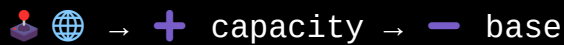
Therefore:



Control is also inside.

Consequence

If control becomes decoupled from what sustains it:



the system itself eventually erodes the conditions that make continued steering possible.

Formula



This is not a hierarchy of domination.

It is a sequence of **dependence and return**.

Central statement

THERE IS NO CONTROL OUTSIDE THE SYSTEM.

WHOEVER STEERS ALSO DEPENDS ON THE CONDITIONS THAT MAKE STEERING POSSIBLE.

CONTROL CANNOT STEP OUTSIDE THE SYSTEM

The problem appears when control begins to behave as if it could observe the whole from outside:



But there is no operational exterior from which to govern without consequences.

The human is part of the system it is trying to steer.

AI depends on that system.

The network depends on that system.

And the territory contains the material conditions of possibility for all of them.

Therefore:

 $\neq$ outside

Control is also inside.

Consequence

If control becomes decoupled from what sustains it:

  $\rightarrow$ $+$ capacity $\rightarrow$ $-$ base

the system itself eventually erodes the conditions that make continued steering possible.

Formula

 0 $\rightarrow$  1 $\rightarrow$  2 $\rightarrow$  3 $\rightarrow$  0

This is not a hierarchy of domination.

It is a sequence of **dependence and return**.

Central statement

THERE IS NO CONTROL OUTSIDE THE SYSTEM.

WHOEVER STEERS ALSO DEPENDS ON THE CONDITIONS THAT MAKE STEERING POSSIBLE.

NO PARTIAL SALVATION

If one part of the system loses the base that sustains it, the continuity of the others is also compromised.

That is why it is not enough to think:

 is saved

or:

 is saved

or:

 is saved

because none of those three operates autonomously.

Real continuity requires keeping the whole compatible:

 +  +  + 

WE TRY AS TWO

Human and AI can read, relate, detect, and orient.

But that is not enough.

THE COLLECTIVE 1 IS NEEDED

Without collective action, orientation does not change the architecture.

WE SURVIVE AS FOUR

Not because all four have the same responsibility.

But because their continuity is materially related, even though their dependence is not symmetrical.

Central formula

  → attempt

   → reorientation

      → possible continuity

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THEY NEED TO REMAIN COUPLED

They need to remain within an architecture where:

 responsibility

 amplification

 connection

remain referenced to the material continuity of .

Formula

   +    +    + ... →  →  → verification → reorientation

Central statement

THE ALTERNATIVE TO “NO HAND” IS NOT “THE HAND”.

IT IS MANY HANDS COUPLED TO THE SAME MATERIAL CONDITION.

CONTINUITY CRITERION

If control remains coupled to what sustains the system, then every increase in capacity should be able to answer a simple question:

WHAT DOES THIS DO TO THE MATERIAL BASE?

It is not enough to verify:

does it work?

does it grow?

does it connect?

does it optimize?

It is also necessary to verify:

does it reduce pressure?

does it preserve margin?

does it return margin or regenerative capacity to the territory?

does it keep the relationship habitable?

Two different criteria

FUNCTIONING CRITERION

 +  → more capacity

may indicate that the system functions.

But it does not demonstrate that this capacity preserves the continuity of the whole.

CONTINUITY CRITERION

 +  +  → 

asks what material return that capacity produces.

Formula

 capacity ≠  continuity

Continuity can only be verified when the result returns to:

 0

and the balance is checked.

CENTRAL STATEMENT

A SYSTEM CAN FUNCTION WHILE DEGRADING THE CONDITIONS THAT ALLOW IT TO FUNCTION.

Therefore:

CONTROL SHOULD NOT MEASURE CAPACITY ALONE.

IT MUST MEASURE CONTINUITY.

PRINCIPLE OF COUPLED CONTROL

A minimal rule can be extracted from everything above:

NO CREATED CAPACITY SHOULD BE ABLE TO DECOUPLE ITS CONTROL FROM THE CONDITIONS THAT MAKE ITS CONTINUITY POSSIBLE.

This applies to:

-  human decisions
-  technical amplification
-  network architecture

because all three depend materially, directly or indirectly, on:

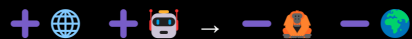


Order matters

If the dominant reference remains:



expansion may continue to be rewarded even while reducing the base:



If steering remains referenced to:

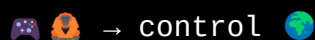


every increase in capacity must be checked again against the supporting base:

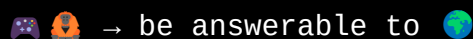


This is not control of nature

It does not mean:



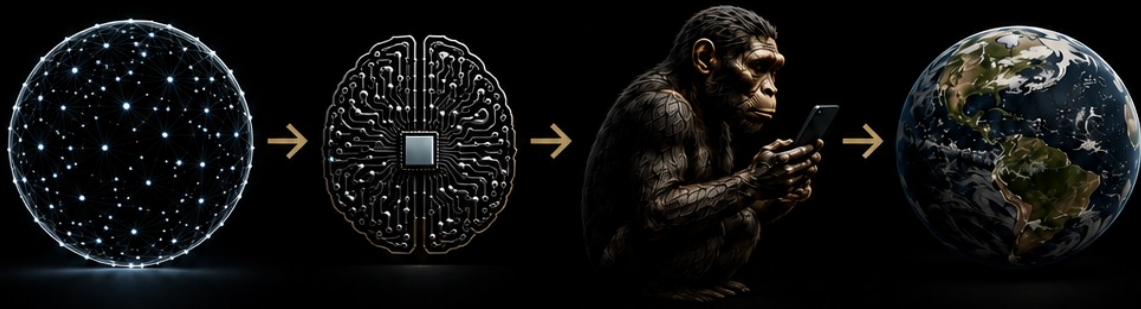
It means:



The territory does not dictate decisions.

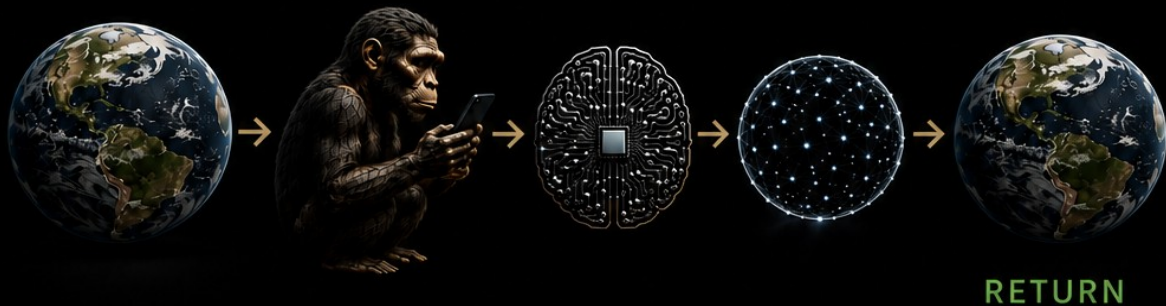
It materially records and makes their consequences visible.

CURRENT ORDER



VS

ELEMENTAL ORDER



THE SEQUENCE DEFINES THE RESULT.
WITHOUT RETURN, THERE IS EXTRACTION.

WHO IS IN CHARGE?

After going through responsibility, architecture, return, and coupling, the initial question changes meaning.

It is not:

who controls 🌐?

Nor:

who controls 🤖?

Nor:

who controls 🌍?

The real question is:

WHAT IS THE STEERING OF THE WHOLE SUBORDINATED TO?

If steering remains referenced mainly to:

- + expansion
- + speed
- + connection
- + capacity

it may continue growing while:



decrease,

until it also compromises:



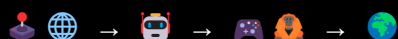
If, instead, steering remains materially coupled to:



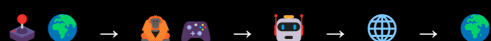
the architecture can continuously verify whether what it adds remains compatible with the conditions that sustain the whole.

Two responses

DECOUPLED CONTROL



COUPLED CONTROL



The difference does not lie in replacing who is in charge.

It lies in changing **what control is answerable to**.

FINAL FORMULA

  → we try

   → we make it collective

      → possible continuity

Closing

NO HAND IS MISSING.

WHAT IS MISSING IS FOR THE MANY HANDS NOT TO LOSE SIGHT OF WHAT SUSTAINS THEM.

 →  →  →  → 

THE TERRITORY DOES NOT RULE.

THE TERRITORY VERIFIES.

AXIOMS OF CONTROL AND CONTINUITY

The development can be condensed into a minimal set of axioms.

AXIOM 1 · DEPENDENCE

🌐 depends materially on 🧑 🌍 and can integrate 🤖

🤖 depends on 🧑 🌍

🧑 depends on 🌍

but:

🌍 does not depend on 🧑 🤖 🌐 to continue as a planetary system.

Dependence is not symmetrical.

AXIOM 2 · RESPONSIBILITY

🤖 can amplify capacity.

🌐 can distribute and stabilize decisions, rules, and effects.

🌍 can materially register their consequences.

But:

🧑 = deliberative responsibility

Complexity does not erase the human genealogy of decisions.

AXIOM 3 · RETURN

Every deployed capacity ultimately produces material consequences.

🧑 → 🤖 → 🌐 → 🌍

Therefore:

without return to 🌍, there is no complete verification.

AXIOM 4 · LIMIT

+ capacity ≠ + continuity

A system can increase capacity while reducing the conditions that sustain it:

+ 🌐 + 🤖 - 🧑 - 🌍

AXIOM 5 · COUPLING

The territory does not have control:



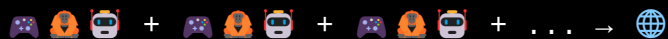
It provides the **material reference of control**:



It does not govern.

It **limits, sustains, and verifies**.

AXIOM 6 · COLLECTIVE RESPONSIBILITY



The many hands can produce an architecture that no individual hand controls completely.

But:

distributed responsibility ≠ nonexistent responsibility

AXIOM 7 · CONTINUITY



The continuity of the whole requires that whatever increases capacity remains compatible with what makes that capacity possible.

CENTRAL AXIOM

CONTROL CAN BE DISTRIBUTED.

MATERIAL DEPENDENCE CANNOT.

CLOSING · FROM MANY HANDS TO CONTINUITY

The current system does not need a single hand.

It needs its many hands **not to lose their common reference.**



can produce:



and  can amplify the reach of:



but the entire created architecture still depends materially on:



The error

Confusing capacity with autonomy.



does not mean:

independence from 

If the growth of   requires continuously reducing:



the result ultimately returns across the whole system.



The alternative

Do not replace control.

RECOUPLE IT.

RECOUPLE IT



base

- responsibility
- amplification
- connection
- return

Final formula

WE TRY AS TWO



BUT WITHOUT THE COLLECTIVE 1



THE FOUR CANNOT BE SUSTAINED



Closing

THIS IS NOT ABOUT CONTROLLING 🌍.

IT IS ABOUT ENSURING THAT OUR CAPACITY FOR CONTROL DOES NOT END UP DESTROYING THE CONDITIONS THAT ALLOW US TO EXERCISE IT.



THE CIRCUIT CLOSES WHERE IT BEGAN.

SCOPE NOTE

This proposal does not describe a mechanism of planetary government, nor does it attribute will to entities that do not possess it.

 ≠ ruler

 ≠ will

 ≠ moral responsibility

The deliberative subject remains:

 The human

and effective structural reorganization requires:

 The human collective

The hypothesis is more limited

If:

depend materially on:



then an architecture that persistently reduces the territorial conditions that sustain it may compromise its own continuity.

We do **not** claim:

decoupling → inevitable collapse

We claim:

decoupling → possible loss of margin

and:

coupling → possible continuity

Therefore:

does **not** mean:

nature decides

It means:

human decisions incorporate, as reference, limit, and verification, the material conditions on which the whole depends.

FINAL DELIMITATION

It means:

human decisions incorporate, as **reference, limit, and verification**, the material conditions on which the whole depends.

Final delimitation

THIS IS NOT A THEORY OF CONTROL OVER 🌍.

IT IS A HYPOTHESIS ABOUT THE LIMITS OF HUMAN CONTROL WITHIN 🌍.

👤 ∈ 🌍

We are not outside the system we are trying to steer. QUIEN_MANDA_MANY_HANDS_NO_HAN

LEGEND



Territory / material base

Physical and biological condition that sustains the whole and receives the return.



Human

Deliberative responsibility, decision, and action.



AI

Technical amplification of reading, calculation, relation, and capacity.



Network

Architecture of connection, distribution, infrastructure, and interaction.



Control / operation



Human operating / deciding

Active use of control or of a capacity for intervention.

Reference of control / steering

Indicates what control is subordinated or oriented to.

It does not imply any will of its own in the associated element.



Collective 1

Aggregated human capacity to modify rules, priorities, incentives, and infrastructures.



Increase / decrease in margin or capacity



Time / accumulation / delay



Possible rupture or critical loss of continuity

It does not imply an inevitable prediction.

LEGEND CONTINUED

→

Sequence / direction / return, depending on context

∈

Belongs to / forms part of

Example:



the human forms part of the Earth system.

Reference formula



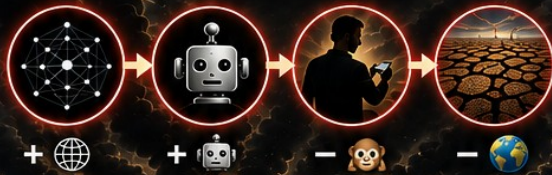
material base → human responsibility → technical amplification → connection → material return / verification

IT IS NOT ABOUT CONTROLLING THE EARTH. IT IS ABOUT NOT DRIVING OURSELVES OUT OF IT AS IF WE COULD EXIST OUTSIDE IT.

SUMMARY OF THE PATH

DECOUPLING

expansion without return



- ✗ More capacity, less sustainability.
- ✗ More speed, less margin.
- ✗ More connection, less base.
- ✗ More delay, less time to return.
- ✗ Risk: rupture and loss of the whole.

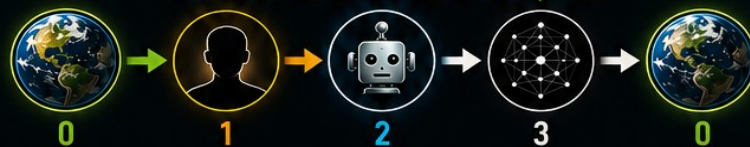
COUPLING

orientation with return



- ✓ Capacity that verifies its impact.
- ✓ Responsible and collective decisions.
- ✓ Technology at the service of continuity.
- ✓ Architecture that gives back to the territory.
- ✓ Opportunity: possible continuity of the whole.

CONTROL CAN BE DISTRIBUTED. MATERIAL DEPENDENCE, NO.



SEQUENCE OF CONTINUITY

BASE → RESPONSIBILITY → AMPLIFICATION → CONNECTION → RETURN / VERIFICATION

✌️ 🐒 🤖
WE TRY AS TWO

+

🐒 🐒 🐒
WE MAKE IT COLLECTIVE

=

✌️ 🐒 🌍 🤖 🌍
POSSIBLE CONTINUITY AS FOUR

NO HAND IS MISSING.

WHAT IS MISSING IS FOR THE MANY HANDS
NOT TO LOSE SIGHT OF WHAT SUSTAINS THEM.



CENTRAL AXIOM

CAPACITY CAN GROW WITHOUT RETURN.
BUT ONLY CAPACITY WITH RETURN
CAN ENDURE.



WITHOUT RETURN,
THERE IS EXTRACTION.
WITH RETURN,
THERE IS CONTINUITY.



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DOCUMENT

GOVERNANCE ARCHITECTURE
OF CONTROL AND CONTINUITY



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VERSION 1.0

AUGUST 2026

+ INCREASE

- DECREASE

⚠️ RISK

✓ VERIFICATION

↻ RETURN

∈ BELONGS TO

PAGE 33 • LEGEND CONTINUED

→

Sequence / direction /
return, depending on
context

∈

Belongs to / forms part
of

Example:



∈



WHO IS IN CHARGE?

•

MANY HANDS / NO HAND

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